FOR TEENAGERS WHOSE BRAINS WORK DIFFERENTLY

Start your schoolwork, get back to it, ask for what helps, find friendly people. *You decide each step.*

For teenagers about 13 to 17, for example autistic, ADHD or dyslexic, and anyone who finds these moments hard.

YOUR NEXT STEP

Write a short reflection

from line 3 of the instructions

You chose this

WHAT GOES WRONG, AND WHAT HELPS

Nothing happens until you decide.

Start

Knowing what to do, but not how to start.

Small steps, each with its line.

Stuck? Make it smaller.

How we know: 274 public posts.

Come back

One interruption wipes out your place.

Leave a note; it waits for you.

Then pick what is next.

How we know: 271 public posts.

Say what you need

Explaining yourself, again and again.

A card about what helps you.

Ask a teacher. No medical label needed.

How we know: 455 posts, mostly at work.

Find your people

Feeling alone, with nowhere safe online.

Rooms for drawing, games, animals, music and more.

Practice rooms, plus a live test for adults.

How we know: a review of 41 studies.

ENERGY TODAY A little · Some · Plenty. On a low-energy day it shows just the next step. Stopping early still counts.

TRY IT IN FIVE MINUTES

1. **Open the made-up homework** and see each task next to its line.
2. **Pick "A little" energy.** Only one step shows.
3. **Ask a teacher** from the Say tab. You send it yourself.
4. **Make a picture** from little picture stamps, or a tune from ready-made sounds, in People.

WHAT STAYS PRIVATE

Your work stays on your phone or computer. *Nothing leaves unless you choose.* No sign-up.

HOW WE KNOW, AND WHAT WE DON'T

1,296 public posts and published studies show these problems are real for some people, mostly adults at work. No young person has used the app yet, so we don't know if it helps. Paid sessions with teenagers come next.

TRY IT NOW

mehtama1234.github.io/neuro-divergent

Works in the web browser on a phone or laptop. Scan the code with your camera.

HELP US TEST IT

Are these the right four problems? What would you change? Tell us at next-step-live.onrender.com/feedback. Made by Amishi Mehta.

An early test version. Every example is made up, and it does not diagnose anything. Please don't type real names, school or health details.

Plain answers. *Including what we don't know yet.*

Is this a diagnosis tool?

No. It never asks about, guesses or shows a medical label like ADHD or autism. It helps with the task in front of you.

Where does my information go?

Your work is saved only on your own phone or computer. No sign-up. Things leave it only when you choose: a post in the live test rooms (wiped daily), an answer in the feedback form, talking instead of typing (your browser turns your voice into words; we keep no recording), and optional AI help.

What does the AI do?

Nothing until you switch it on. Then it can suggest words or double-check tasks. Before anything goes to the AI service you connect (you choose it), it takes out email addresses and web links and shows you exactly what will be sent. It never sends a message to a person for you.

Did you test it with real people?

Not yet. It started from personal experience, then public online posts, published studies and a look at similar apps. Next, we plan to pay teenagers to help shape it, then run a careful study approved by an ethics board.

Is the community safe for teenagers?

Practice rooms run on your device, with made-up people. A live test lets adults try the rooms, but its sign-in and parent checks are pretend, so it is not for teenagers yet. The plan: small rooms by age group, with pretend names and a trained adult checking every post first. No photos, voice, private messages or like counts. Before any real teenager uses it: a named child-safety lead, trained checkers and a lawyer's review.

How does voice work?

You tap to start. The words appear for you to fix, and nothing is added until you choose "Use these words". Typing always works too. Talking needs the internet and works best in Chrome; it may not work on iPhone. Reading words aloud works without the internet.

Does it work on a phone, and offline?

Yes, in the phone's web browser, and without the internet after your first visit (except talking to type). App-store versions exist but have not been tried on real phones yet.

Who is it for?

Teenagers (about 13 to 17) whose brains work differently, for example autistic, ADHD or dyslexic, and anyone who finds long instructions, interruptions or explaining their needs hard. It helps alongside how you already talk and write; it does not replace it.

How do you know the software works?

We wrote 637 small computer tests that use the app by themselves. 625 pass; the 12 that fail need files from other build steps or another computer. Tests check the app works as built. They cannot tell us if it helps anyone.

How do you know these problems are real?

We read 1,296 public Reddit and LinkedIn posts and published studies. For example, 274 posts describe not being able to start, 271 losing your place after an interruption, and 455 asking for changes. Most are from adults, often at work, so we still need to hear from teenagers about school.

STILL WONDERING? *Ask us. If we don't know yet, we will say so, and add it to the questions for the first study.*